

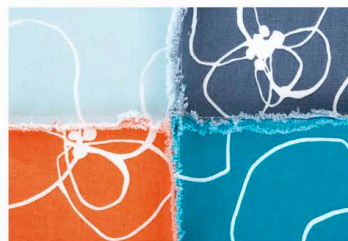
▶ FRAYED PATCHWORK

Seams do not always have to be hidden away. By sewing pieces wrong sides together the seams will show on the outside of the patchwork piece. While there are more involved ways of sewing frayed seams, the method

shown below is the easiest. Do not quilt over the frayed seams as it will flatten the fluffy edges, only quilt inside the seams.



1 Piece your patchwork in the normal way, but sew all of the pieces wrong sides together. Carefully snip into the seam allowance and use a pin to tease out a few threads from the edge.

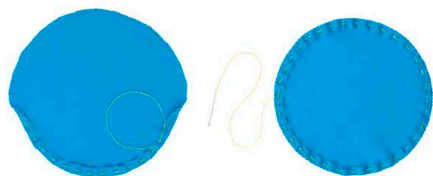


2 Putting the piece through a wash and dry cycle will really fluff up the raw edges. When the patchwork is complete it will create a lovely chenille effect, great for baby quilts.

▶ YO-YOS

Yo-yos, also called Suffolk puffs, are fabric circles that have been gathered to make two layers. They are widely used as decorations in appliqué and can be further embellished. Joined edge to edge, they can be made

into tablecloths, cushion covers, or openwork bedcovers. Yo-yo projects are a great way to use up small scraps of fabric.

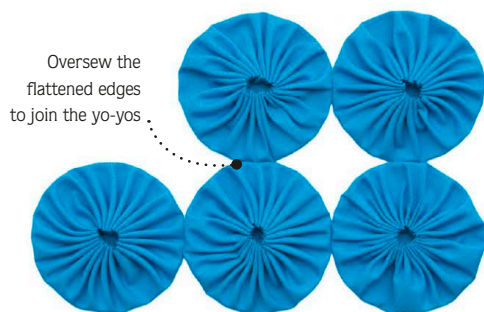


1 Cut circles of fabric twice the desired finished size. Knot a length of strong thread, doubled if necessary, and secure it close to the edge on the wrong side of the circle. Turn the raw edge 6mm (1/4in) to the wrong side and take small gathering stitches through both layers all around the edge, to make a single hem. Finish next to where you started.



Gently pull the thread to gather the circle

2 Do not remove the needle or cut the thread, but pull the thread gently to gather the circle into a smaller one, with pleats around the centre. The raw edge will disappear inside the circle. Secure the thread with a couple of tacks or back stitches, then knot it. Cut the thread. Flatten the circle by gently fingerpressing the edges. The gathered side is usually the front, but sometimes the back is used instead.



Oversew the flattened edges to join the yo-yos

3 To join yo-yos, place them gathered sides facing and oversew the flattened edges for a short distance, taking small, tight stitches. Join yo-yos together until you have a row that is the desired length; join rows together in the same way.